Harness Engineering

Raising the floor on what agents ship

LLMs are excellent at code design.

By default, they ship crap.

The wrong question

> What does it do?

The right question

> What can we make it do?

The harness

Everything that shapes the agent.

> `AGENTS.md` / `CLAUDE.md`
>
> Skills
>
> Referenced docs — principles, ADRs
>
> Workflow & process
>
> Scripts and quality gates
>
> Hooks and sub-agents
>
> The shape of the repo itself

The kata

Same feature. Many runs.

Throw the code away. Keep the harness.

Today: 1 3 4+5 6 7

Anything we can verify, we can delegate.

The engineering is articulating our intuition until it becomes verifiable.

Where review goes

Every recurring correction is a **harness bug**.

Human review's highest-leverage output is **a harness change**.

Recursive

The agent can help build **its own harness**.

`Skills` `Principles` `Scripts` `Gates`
`Agent reviews` `CI` `Any feedback mechanism`

Raise the floor.
Then raise it again.

`github.com/martinsson/harness-engineering-kata`

Questions · Pushback · Demo